The project began when I read page 138 of *The ABCs of Conceptual Writing*, specifically the section on alphabetical order. In the last few parts of the first paragraph, Jacquelyn Ardam mentions that literary texts sometimes scramble the alphabet to express different ideas. For example, a strict alphabetical order is utopian, while scrambling it possesses a dystopian beauty. This also reminded me of an experiment on the Chinese internet a few years ago—or rather, a prank. Someone would replace a piece of text with homophones and shuffle the order to pass the censorship of some online platforms. When others saw and read it aloud, they subconsciously read the text in the original order. Ultimately, people reached a seemingly joking conclusion: scrambling the order of Chinese text doesn't actually affect readability. This is largely due to the relatively fixed meanings of each Chinese word and their tendency to appear in a specific order. So, I was thinking that when I first saw American internet slang like "lol" or "lmao," it was just a random jumble of meaningless letters to me, but it meant something different to others. So I wanted to create a near-random letter generator that could form words, phrases, or sentences. But at the same time, I wanted to make it fun, otherwise it would just look like the name generator in *The Nine Billion Names of God*. Ultimately, I decided to make a game, preferably a modified version of an existing game, so I wouldn't have to spend too much time figuring out how it worked.

I finally decided to use Tetris for a few reasons. First, it's simple, or rather, basic, like vodka in cocktails—coincidentally, both originated in Russia. Second, Tetris reminded me of Cut-up; the gameplay involves cutting different pieces of paper into different shapes and then piecing them together. I randomly filled letters into different blocks, and the player could rotate the blocks to get different letters in the corresponding rows. Furthermore, underscores are used instead of spaces, allowing for varying numbers of words per line or different numbers of letters per word. The final adjustment to the game itself is the removal of scores and timers. I don't believe this is a competitive game, just as math isn't limited to tax returns and pay stubs. I want the gameplay environment to be more player-driven, while scores and timers only create tension, which is detrimental to creativity.

My idea for this game is similar to Cut-up, except that a typical Cut-up cuts out complete words or phrases from a newspaper or magazine, while my game goes down to each individual letter. This also expresses my idea about Cut-up: the purpose of doing something, whether successful or not, will ultimately lead to the outcome you desire. When your goal is to clear everything, you'll find the game not difficult. You'll likely end up with a bunch of gibberish, but a lot, a huge amount, proving you've cleared a lot of blocks—you're a master. If you intend to only eliminate meaningful words or phrases, while difficult, it's possible. Perhaps you'll end up with a few meaningful but largely unrelated words or phrases, but that's still an achievement.

Finally, I want to point out a commonality between my project and Cut-up, which is also a point of personal disappointment for me. Both have their limitations. In my game, you can't control what the next block will be or what letters it contains. Similarly, Cut-up is limited by the text you can find, especially printed text. You'll rarely see words like Deimos or Pluto in entertainment magazines. This might be painful for those who enjoy free creation, but if good literature can be created in such a restrictive environment, I think it's like a flower growing in the permafrost of a high mountain—rare, but beautiful nonetheless.